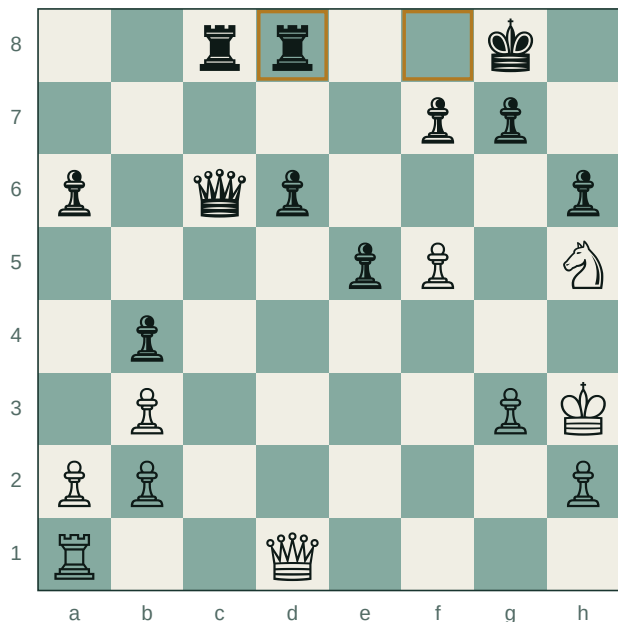


Double checks: White, move 32

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 31...Rfd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32. Qg4 g6 33. fxg6 d5 34. gxf7+

32.Qg4 The queen moves from d1 to g4. Recorded reply: **32...g6**.

33.fxg6 The pawn captures the pawn on g6. The changed line means the queen on g4 attacks the rook on c8. Recorded reply: **33...d5**.

34.gxf7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the queen on g4 attacks the king on g8.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -3 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.